Robert Manz

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SUMMARY

Product-minded operator and former venture investment analyst with a Northwestern Kellogg Product Management Certificate. Evaluated B2B SaaS products and founders, worked with a portfolio founder on positioning, ideal customer profile, and acquisition channels, and used AI tools to cut month-end close time by 50%. Seeking a product management role where customer research, market analysis, and clear writing drive roadmap decisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Growth & Operations Lead | Wholesale Auto Gear, Cincinnati, OH January 2025 – September 2026

- Used AI tools to streamline QuickBooks bookkeeping and sales reporting, cutting month-end close time by 50%
- Launched the brand's social media and content strategy, generating 75% of inbound leads
- Built revenue forecasts, operating budgets, and capex models to prioritize inventory, equipment, and vehicle investments
- Ran monthly budget-vs-actual variance analysis in Excel with pivot tables to guide spending decisions
- Managed project tracking for logistics and delivery schedules across key wholesale accounts

Career Break | Family Caregiving April 2024 – December 2024

Investment Analyst | R1 Capital (formerly Rev1 Ventures), Columbus, OH September 2022 – March 2024

- Wrote and presented 3 investment memos that won $2M+ in approved funding for B2B SaaS startups
- Worked directly with a portfolio founder to define positioning, ideal customer profile, and acquisition channels
- Ran diligence on 5 early-stage startups, assessing market size and adoption risk through customer research
- Built revenue forecasts and unit economics models (pricing, CAC, LTV) to test company plans
- Tracked portfolio company KPIs and prepared performance reports for the investment team
- Built and maintained 35+ investor and founder relationships across the Midwest, increasing qualified deal flow by 20%
- Owned the investor database supporting follow-on fundraising, cutting outreach time by 30%

Venture Capital Intern | Refinery Ventures, Cincinnati, OH March 2022 – May 2022

- Evaluated early-stage B2B SaaS startups on product potential, market traction, competitive position, and founder fit to guide partner interest

PROJECTS

Ladder | Career search CRM, Santa Clara, CA 2026

- Built a job-search and networking CRM with Claude Code, deployed and hosted it, and integrated it with Gmail, Google Calendar, Zoom, Granola, WisprSync, and an open-source AI companion interface

LEADERSHIP

Founder & President | Bearcat Ventures, Cincinnati, OH August 2021 – April 2022

- Founded a student-led venture fund and raised $1.2M to invest in University of Cincinnati alumni startups
- Designed a training curriculum on core VC strategy, sourcing, and diligence to prepare students for VC internships
- Partnered with regional VC firms to build intern pipelines and led UC's first team to a global VC competition

EDUCATION

Product Management Certificate | Northwestern University, Kellogg School of Management February 2025

BBA, Finance & Entrepreneurship | University of Cincinnati April 2022

- GPA in Majors: 4.0 | Cumulative: 3.8 | Dean’s List 2020–2022
- 2022 Student Leader of the Year | 2022 Outstanding Student in Entrepreneurship

SKILLS & TOOLS

Product: Customer Research ● Market Analysis ● Go-to-Market Strategy ● Product Strategy ● KPI Tracking ● Unit Economics ● Stakeholder Communication
Tools: Notion ● Claude ● Claude Code ● Excel (Pivot Tables) ● Google Sheets ● PowerPoint ● QuickBooks ● SQL (currently learning)